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2 July 54

DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
HEADQUARTERS UNITED STATES AIR FORCE
WASHINGTON D C

REPLY TO ATTN OF: DEPUTY INSPECTOR GENERAL FOR INSPECTION AND SAFETY (USAF) AFIAS-RI

27 Oct 1967

SUBJECT: Aircraft Accident Summary (Ltr, TDEI/UFO, 18 Oct 1967)

TO: FTD (TDEI/UFO)

In response to your request, a summary of circumstances has been prepared on the 2 July 1954, F-94C accident (attachment 1). It is hoped that the summary is sufficient for your purposes.

FOR THE CHIEF OF STAFF

William Tussler

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Summary of Circumstances

WILLIAM TUSSLER
Chief, Re[illegible] Investigation Group
Directorate of Aerospace Safety

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SUMMARY OF CIRCUMSTANCES

At 1127 Eastern Standard Time (EST), July 2, 1954, F-94C 51-13559 crashed three miles east of Westmorland (referred to as the Walesville intersection), New York and was destroyed. The pilot and radar observer of the aircraft ejected successfully and were uninjured. However, the aircraft struck a civilian dwelling and a civilian automobile, fatally injuring a total of four persons.

The aircraft took off at 11:05 EST on a routine training mission. An afterburner takeoff was made and engine operation was normal. The afterburner was shut off at 2,500 feet and level flight was assumed. At the request of the ground controlled intercept (GCI) site, the mission of the aircraft was changed to airborne intercept and an afterburner climb was made to 12,000 feet. A visual sighting of the unidentified aircraft was made at 10,000 feet, but because of the slow speed of the unidentified aircraft, the pilot of the F-94C employed dive brakes, flaps and, at the same time, reduced the throttle to approximately 65 percent rpm. After identifying the C-47 aircraft by tail number, the pilot turned his attention to a second unidentified aircraft. The GCI informed the pilot that the second unidentified aircraft was probably low and letting down for

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a landing at Griffiss Air Force Base.

As the pilot started a descent, he noted that the cockpit temperature increased abruptly. The increase in temperature caused the pilot to scan the instruments. The fire warning light was on and the pilot informed the radar observer of this fact. The fire warning light remained on after the throttle was placed in "idle" so the engine was shut down and both crew members ejected successfully.

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